

Riley Bloom

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling ordered you to add a gaudy lighting cue to the unveiling and threatened to withhold payment when Lucian objected.

What you are hiding

You secretly changed the cue again after approval, causing the eerie light flickers guests noticed during Act I. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

What you know about other guests

- Sterling borrowed heavily from Imogen's concept for the gala reveal.
- Lucian has been threatened with nonpayment over a last-minute display demand.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Lucian was with you adjusting the centerpiece lighting through the critical window.

IF MURDERER

You entered the salon at 6:44 to retrieve a lighting remote, poisoned the cordial, and left a gold ribbon fiber on the tray.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I secretly changed the approved lighting cue, which is why the centerpiece flickered so ominously during Act I. Sterling had demanded something gaudier, Lucian hated it, and I tried to split the difference without telling either of them. The lighting log puts me at the console when the drink was poisoned.

IF MURDERER

Sterling threatened not to pay unless I gave him the spectacle he wanted, then prepared to blame me for the result. I went into the salon under cover of retrieving a remote, poisoned the cordial, and left a gold ribbon fiber on the glass. I wanted one perfect gasp tonight. I got the wrong one.

Investigation notes
